

ECONOMY 24

SERVICES, DIGITAL ECONOMY, FINTECH AND PLATFORM MARKETS

OPEN RAILS -> ACCOUNTABLE APPLICATIONS -> INCLUSIVE DIGITAL PRODUCTIVITY

01

SERVICES MAP

- Heterogeneous market, public and social activities
- Tradable / non-tradable; formal / informal
- Output share, employment and productivity are separate

02

STRUCTURAL TRANSFORMATION

- Modern services support exports and knowledge
- Domestic services absorb labour and provide welfare
- India needs services-manufacturing complementarity

03

DIGITAL ECONOMY STACK

- Connectivity and cloud
- Identity, payments, documents and consented data
- Intermediaries and applications
- Outcome depends on competition and capability

04

PAYMENT ARCHITECTURE

- RBI regulates; NPCI operates specified retail systems
- PSP bank, issuer bank and TPAP retain distinct roles
- NEFT batch; RTGS gross; IMPS and UPI instant retail

05

UPI VERSUS CBDC

- UPI moves commercial-bank deposits
- e-rupee is RBI liability and legal tender
- RBI FAQ 29 Apr 2026: pilots continue

06

DIGITAL LENDING

- RE remains liable for LSP
- Direct borrower-RE fund flow
- KFS, APR, cooling-off and grievance
- DLG ceiling: 5% of specified portfolio

07

ACCOUNT AGGREGATOR

- RBI Directions 28 Nov 2025

07

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- RBI Directions 28 Nov 2025
- Explicit, revocable consent artefact
- No transaction support, no data residence
- AA transmits data, FIU decides

08

ONDC

- Open protocol across buyer and seller applications
- DPIIT initiative; not one marketplace
- Interoperability must be paired with trust and grievance

09

PLATFORM POWER

- Cross-side network effects improve matching
- Data and switching costs can tip markets
- Self-preferencing, tying and ranking require effects analysis

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DATA + COMPETITION LAW

- DPDP phased from 13 Nov 2025
- CCI enforces existing competition law
- March 2024 ex-ante draft not enacted by cutoff

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INCLUSION + RESILIENCE

- Access + affordability + skills + accessibility
- Cyber: prevent, detect, contain, recover
- Digital-only delivery can exclude

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ANSWER SPINE

- Define rail, actor and legal status
- Date rule and statistic
- Trace productivity and network effects
- Test competition, privacy, stability and remedy